



GERMAN SENTENCE STRUCTURE

Cheat Sheet



EMMALOVESGERMAN.COM

How to Use this Cheat Sheet

Thank you for downloading this German Sentence Structure Cheat Sheet. After working through this PDF you'll have a 'bird's eye' view of how German sentence structure works including all the elements you need to create German sentences thanks to my unique 'Building Blocks Method'.

The first 3 pages break down the 'rules' of German sentence structure & the following 4 pages are flow chart style posters to help you visualise how certain sentences are formed.

You're welcome (and encouraged) to print this PDF so that you always have a visual aid as you create your own sentences.

If you'd like to share this PDF I would be grateful if you could share the link to the download page:

emmalovesgerman.com/sentence-cheat-sheet



I'm Emma, & at the grand age of 34 I started learning German. Despite totally failing my 2 years of German at school, I managed to become fluent in the language in around 3 years through self study.

My aim is to get you enjoying learning German as much as I do & to help make this sometimes confusing language, that bit easier (even if you think you don't have the 'language gene')!

German Sentence Structure

Use the **SVO (subject verb object)** structure for basic sentences

Keep the conjugated **verb in position 2** (almost always!) Example: *Ich esse Pizza.*

Use the '**WHEN WHY / HOW WHERE**' rule.
Example: *Ich fahre um 18 Uhr mit meiner Freunde zum Flughafen.*

Remember some flexibility in German sentences. **Time can move to position 1.**
Example: *Mittwochs gehe ich ins Fitnessstudio.*

For 2 objects in a sentence:
Subject + Verb + Indirect Object + Direct Object.

Example: *Ich gebe dem Lehrer das Buch.*

For separable verbs: **Prefix goes to very end.**

Example: *Ich komme um 10 Uhr am Bahnhof an.*
(ankommen)

If 2 verbs: **Conjugated verb** in position 2,
unconjugated verb goes to the end.

Example: *Ich **gehe** in den Laden, um Brot zu **kaufen**.*

Put modal verbs conjugated in position 2
(always!)

Example: *Ich muss zum Zahnarzt gehen.*

Put the **future tense verb (werden)** in position 2. Other verb goes to end. Example: *Ich werde ins Kino gehen.*

Don't separate separable verbs when used with a modal verb. **Modal verb** goes in position 2, unseparated **separable verb** goes to end.

Example: *Sie **sollte** um 9 Uhr **abreisen**.*

For the past tense: Auxiliary verb (**haben** or **sein**) is **conjugated in position 2**. **Main verb** in past tense goes to the end.

Example: *Ich **habe** das Buch **gelesen**.*

For yes/no questions: **Verb moves to position 1, subject goes in position 2**. Example: *Fährst du oft nach Deutschland?*

To use a question word (why, what, where etc.): Question word takes **position 1, verb position 2, subject position 3**.

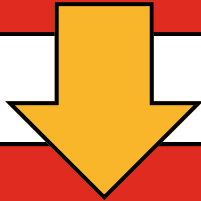
Example: *Warum **bist du** noch zu Hause?*

Conjunctions such as **weil, dass, ob** send the **conjugated verb** to the very end.

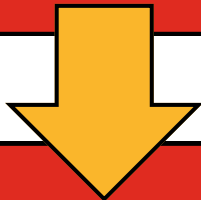
Example: *Ich trinke einen Kaffee, **weil** ich durst **habe**.*

Basic Sentences

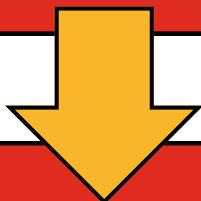
Position 1



Position 2

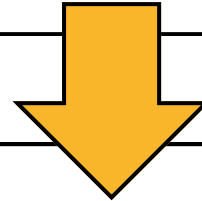


The Middle

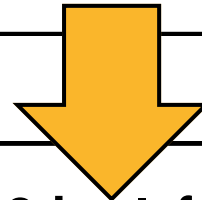


The End

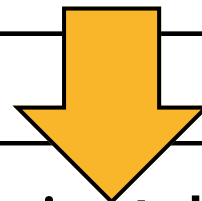
Subject



Conjugated Verb

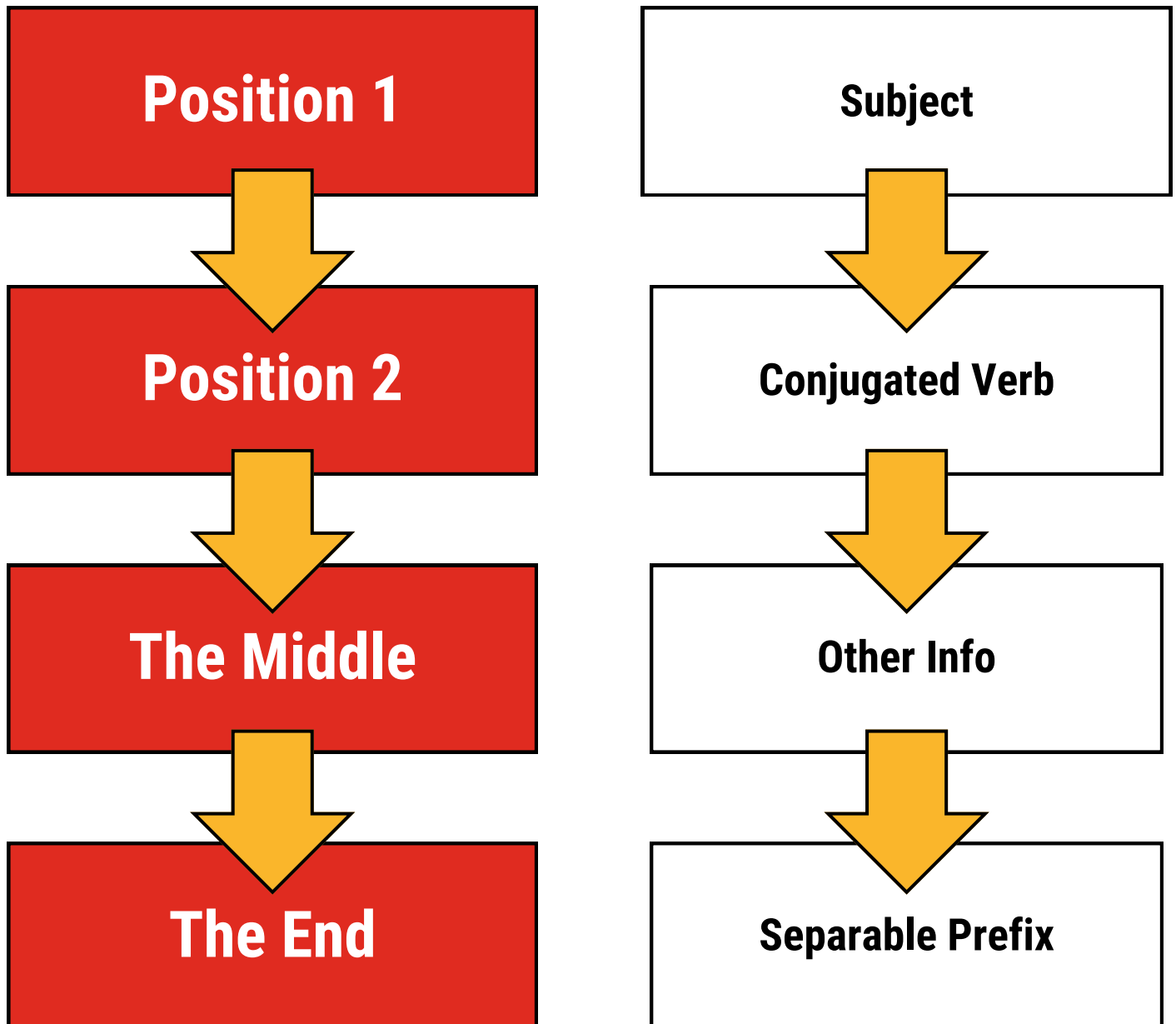


Other Info
(WHEN > WHY > WHERE)

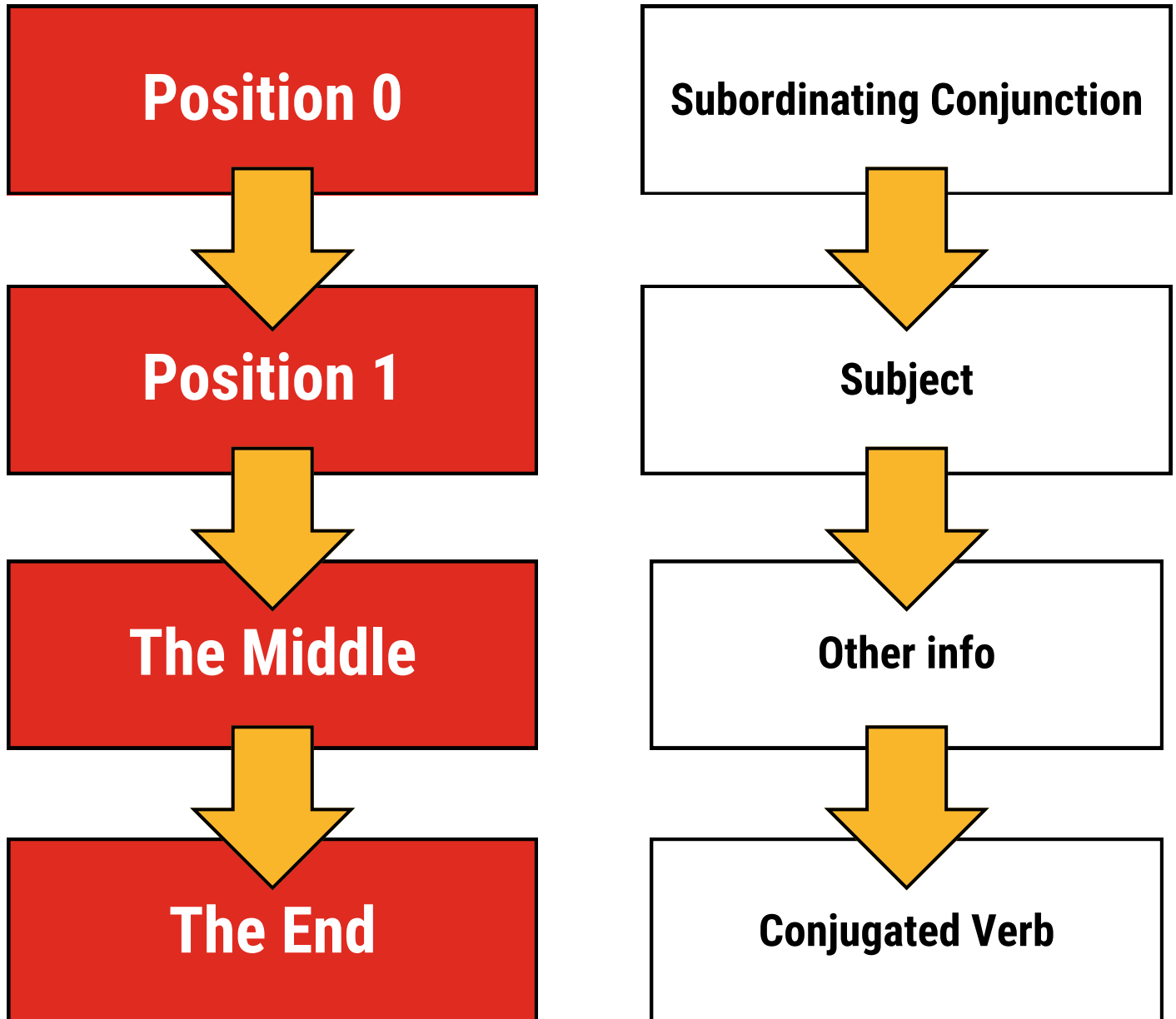


Unconjugated Verb
(if 2 verbs in sentence)

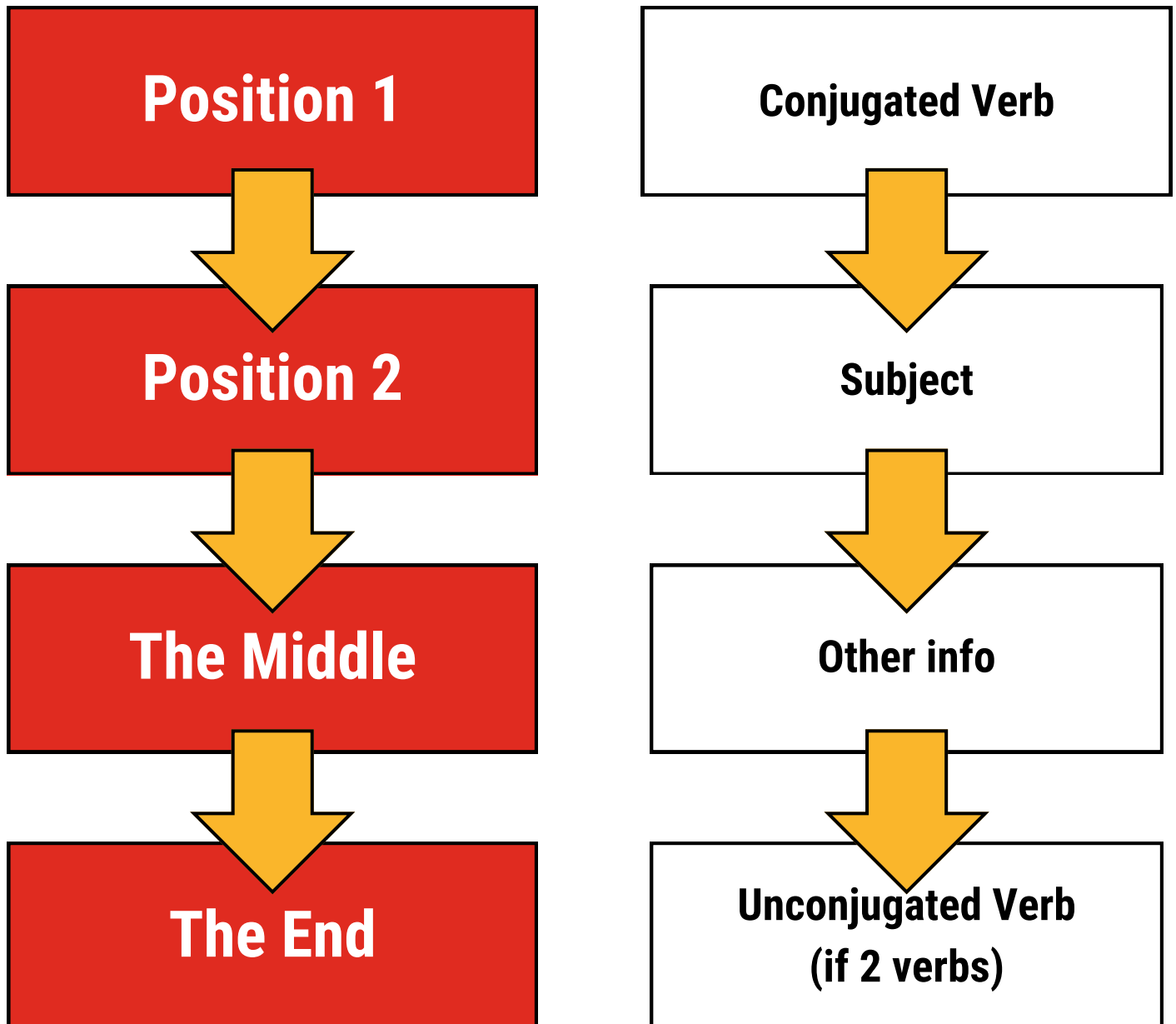
Separable Verbs



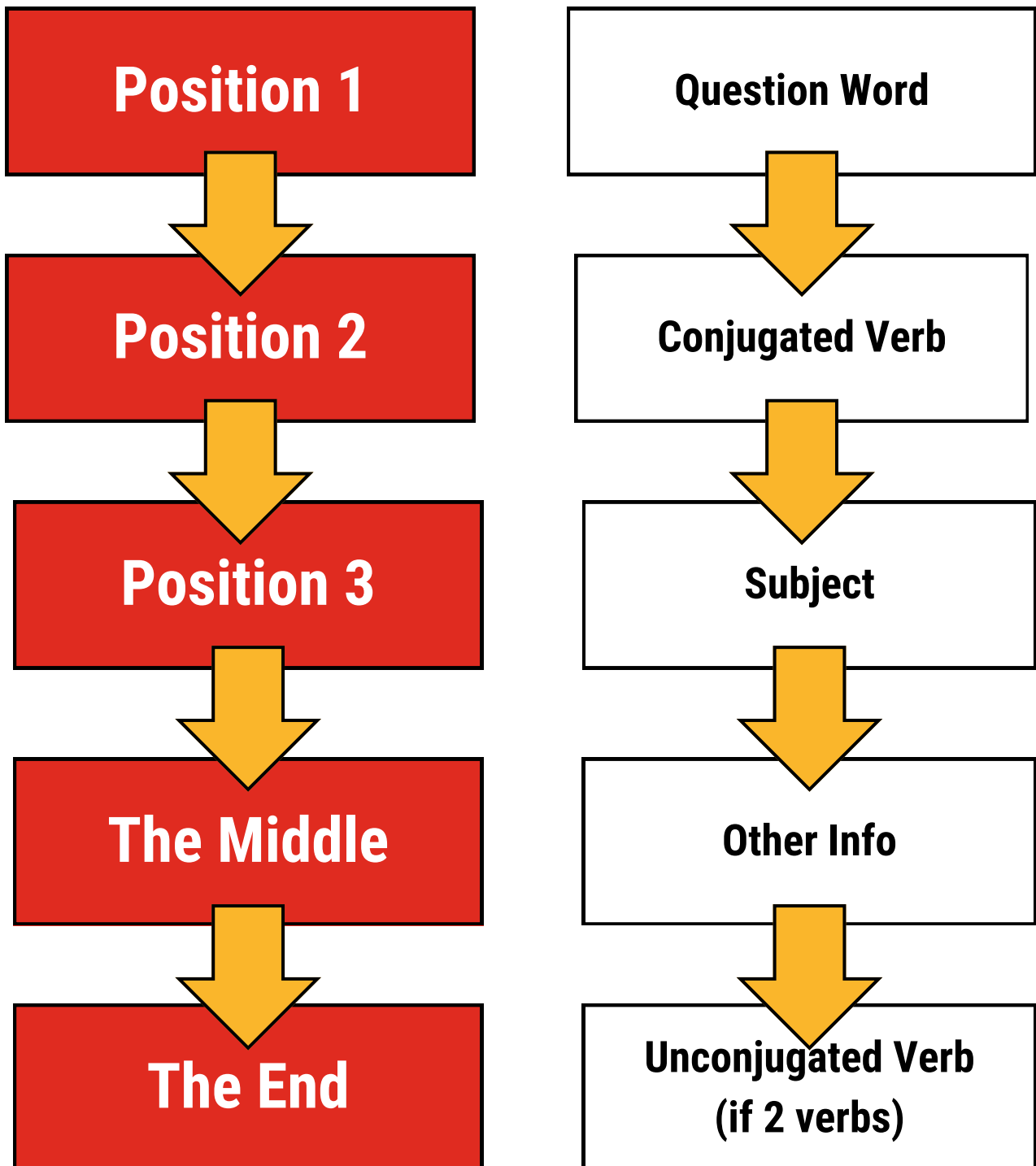
Subordinate Clauses



Yes / No Questions



Question Words



What's Next?

You know that to progress your German you actually need to have some German conversations, but what if the thought of actually having a conversation in German makes your stomach start doing backflips.

I've been there myself & know that gut-wrenching feeling, which is why I created the German Script Builder...

A comprehensive script builder for everyday conversations to help you prepare your own customised scripts that you can put together even if you feel like you can't think fast enough to actually have a conversation in German.

[Check out the German Script Builder today](#) & get ready to have German conversations without the stress.

